Past continuous: what Murphy does not tell you

Day 2 · Grammar beyond Murphy

Murphy first
Murphy red, Unit 13 (pages 36–37): the form, + – ?. Do **13.1, 13.2** in class. Unit 14 (pages 38–39) is next week.
This file adds five things the book does not explain.

1 · Spelling of -ing (Murphy only sends you to Appendix 5)

most verbs: add **-ing**	watch → watching · play → playing · snow → snowing
ends in **-e**: drop the e	make → making · come → coming · dance → dancing (but see → seeing)
one vowel + one consonant, stressed: **double** it	run → running · stop → stopping · swim → swimming · begin → beginning (but visit → visiting)
ends in **-ie** → **-ying**	lie → lying · die → dying

2 · Verbs that do not like -ing

know · like · love · hate · want · need · believe · understand · remember · prefer

✗ I **was knowing** the answer. → ✓ I **knew** the answer.

Careful: *have* and *think* can take -ing, with another meaning: I was having lunch ✓ · I was thinking about you ✓ · I was having a bike ✗

3 · Telling a story: the scene and the events

The past continuous **sets the scene** (weather, what people were doing). The past simple gives the **events**, one after another.

*The sun **was shining** and children **were playing**. Suddenly a dog **ran** out. I **stopped** and **called** its owner.*

Two actions at the same time: *While Dad **was cooking**, I **was doing** my homework.*

As = while: *As I was walking home, it started to rain.*

4 · Time words

at 8 o'clock yesterday
this time last year
all day · all evening · the whole afternoon
at that moment

5 · The Russian trap

«Вчера я смотрел фильм» can be two things. Ask: **did you finish it?** Yes → *I watched a film.* In progress at a moment → *I was watching a film when you called.*

Annoying habit: *He was always losing his keys.*

Practice

Day 2 · Practice 1

What to do: Exercises 1–2 in class, alone, then check. Exercise 3: the class translates aloud, one sentence each.

1 Write the -ing form

1 run → _____
2 make → _____
3 lie → _____
4 stop → _____
5 write → _____
6 visit → _____
7 swim → _____
8 play → _____
9 begin → _____
10 die → _____
11 dance → _____
12 plan → _____

2 Choose the correct form

1. I (knew / was knowing) the answer, but I was too shy to say it.
2. At eight last night we (had / were having) dinner.
3. She (loved / was loving) that song when she was little.
4. He (wanted / was wanting) a new phone, so he saved money.
5. When I arrived, they (watched / were watching) the match.
6. The girl (didn't understand / wasn't understanding) the question.
7. While Dad (cooked / was cooking), my brother (set / was setting) the table.
8. (Did you see / Were you seeing) Anna yesterday?

3 Translate into English

1. В восемь вечера я делал уроки.

2. Мы шли домой, когда начался дождь.

3. Пока мама готовила, я накрывал на стол.

4. Он знал ответ, но молчал.

5. Что ты делал вчера в это время?

6. Весь вечер шёл снег.

7. Он вечно терял ключи.

Practice 2

Day 2 · Practice 2

What to do: Exercise 4: write alone for 5 minutes, then read your sentences aloud: can the class guess who is speaking? Exercise 5: alone.

4 Look and write: what was everybody doing?



the man on the bench



the woman



the boy



the girl



the gardener



the police officer

At 3 p.m. a bag disappeared from a bench in the park. The police officer asks everybody: *What were you doing at three?* Write what each person answers, then add two sentences in the past simple about what happened next.

5 Complete the story: past simple or past continuous?

It was a cold Sunday morning. I (1 walk) _____ through the village when I (2 see) _____ a small dog under a car. It (3 shake) _____ and nobody (4 look) _____ at it. A woman (5 stand) _____ nearby and (6 talk) _____ on the phone. I (7 sit) _____ down and (8 speak) _____ quietly to the dog. After a minute it (9 stop) _____ shaking and (10 come) _____ to me.

Answers · Day 2 grammar

For the teacher

1 running · making · lying · stopping · writing · visiting · swimming · playing · beginning · dying · dancing · planning

2 knew · were having · loved · wanted · were watching · didn’t understand · was cooking, was setting · Did you see

3 At eight in the evening I was doing my homework. · We were walking home when it started to rain. · While Mom was cooking, I was setting the table. · He knew the answer, but he was silent. · What were you doing at this time yesterday? · It was snowing all evening. · He was always losing his keys.

4 Possible: The man was reading a newspaper. The woman was running. The boy was flying a kite. The girl was feeding the ducks. The gardener was watering the flowers. The police officer was talking on the radio. Then a bag disappeared; they all looked at the bench.

5 was walking · saw · was shaking · was looking · was standing · was talking · sat · spoke · stopped · came